



DEFENSE FINANCE AND ACCOUNTING SERVICE

Contract Services Directorate
3990 E. Broad Street
Bldg. 21
Columbus, OH 43213-1152

NOTE: To ensure form populates correctly, enter Estimated Value below under 3. prior to completing any other entries.

FAR 16.5 - Justification for an Exception to Fair Opportunity

BRAND NAME

Purchase Request #(s)

CONTRACTING ACTIVITY: DFAS Contract Services Directorate

1. REQUIRING ACTIVITY:

2. DESCRIPTION OF THE ACTION BEING APPROVED: Solicit a Brand Name requirement and award a Contract/Order.

3. DESCRIPTION OF SUPPLIES/SERVICES: This justification covers the acquisition of the following article(s):

This renewal is for Nutanix AOS (Acropolis Operating System) software for the SIPR environment. This includes software licensing & support intended to integrate with the existing agency-deployed environment and virtualization components. Virtualization provides DFAS with an efficient, agile and economical infrastructure platform by maximizing server resources, consolidating hardware and lowering operational and data center overhead. The virtualization infrastructure Hyper converged infrastructure further consolidates the data center by integrating virtualization and storage platform into a single commodity appliance and aligns DFAS with DISA standards.

This procurement will continue to support the reduction of physical hardware to allow a reduced IT footprint and standardized DFAS storage infrastructure aligned with the DISA migration. This will continue to support the path to standardization to align with DISA technology and consolidation of existing DFAS deployed virtualization and storage infrastructure resources in support of Data Center Optimization Initiative (DCOI).

The Required Delivery Date/PoP is: 05/01/2025 - 4/30/2026

Estimated Value (include options): \$

Option(s)

4. STATUTORY AUTHORITY PERMITTING OTHER THAN FULL AND OPEN COMPETITION:

FAR 16.505(a)(4) Items peculiar to one manufacturer

5. IS THIS JUSTIFICATION FOR A FOLLOW-ON TO AN ORDER PREVIOUSLY ISSUED FOR THE SAME SUPPLY OR SERVICE BASED ON A JUSTIFICATION FOR AN EXCEPTION TO FAIR OPPORTUNITY CITING THE AUTHORITY AT FAR 16.505(b)(2)(i)(B) OR (C)?

NO

a. Approval Signature Level on previous justification:

b. Description of actions taken to remove any barriers to competition cited on the previous justification.

c. Determination as to whether the planned actions to remove any barriers to competition cited on the previous justification were completed:

6. RATIONALE JUSTIFYING USE OF CITED STATUTORY AUTHORITY

The servers already in place throughout DFAS are currently operating using Nutanix software and, for the reasons stated throughout this rationale, there is no other software compatible with the existing servers or sufficient to meet all of DFAS' needs. This software renewal is for DFAS SIPR and must be compatible with the existing DFAS cluster and must be provided by the original manufacturer or an authorized reseller.

DFAS Operations Engineering have performed extensive research for alternative software products; however, the Nutanix Acropolis Operating System (AOS) has proved to be the only hyper-converged operating system that meets all of DFAS' requirements. Nutanix AOS is the only product that supports data locality, integration with DISA provided STIG (Security Technical Implementation Guides) and SCAP (Security Content Automation Protocol) standards, iSCSI (Internet Small Computer System Interface) external presentation, single file restore snapshot granularity, integrated filer server, virtualization components Site Recovery Manager certified, and support for Hyper-V, virtualization components and Acropolis Hypervisors. As such, this procurement is for Nutanix AOS software licenses and

support which will integrate with the existing agency-deployed virtualization components.

Nutanix is the only platform that combines computer, storage and hypervisor support on a single platform. It is unique and has highly specialized features that can only integrate with current DFAS hardware. Nutanix maintains our tech support and warranties. Nutanix is required for continued use of our existing hardware.

The Government's requirements and market research indicates other companies' similar products, do not meet, or cannot be modified to meet, the agency's needs.

7. DESCRIPTION OF EFFORTS MADE TO SOLICIT OFFERS FROM AS MANY OFFERORS AS PRACTICABLE:

An RFI was posted to determine the interested vendor base on

Oct 18, 2024 And closed on Oct 25, 2024 which resulted in responses from interested vendor(s)

8. A SHORT DESCRIPTION OF RESULTS OF RFI/BETA.SAM.GOV POSTING, OR MARKET RESEARCH CONDUCTED OR A STATEMENT OF THE REASON NONE OF THE ABOVE ACTIONS WERE CONDUCTED.

Market Research was initially conducted via NASA SEWP, GSA and ESI which resulted in a total of vendors: SEWP (327196) from GSA (1730594) from and ESI vendors were emailed directly

However the customer was notified by that software part numbers and serial numbers had changed for 2025. As a result additional market research was conducted from which resulted in a responses, see A11 Market Research.

9. LIST OF THE SOURCES THAT EXPRESSED A WRITTEN INTEREST IN THE ACQUISITION.

10. ANY OTHER FACTS SUPPORTING THE USE OF OTHER THAN FULL AND OPEN COMPETITION:

none

11. A STATEMENT OF THE ACTIONS, IF ANY, THE AGENCY MAY TAKE TO REMOVE OR OVERCOME ANY BARRIERS TO COMPETITION BEFORE ANY SUBSEQUENT ACQUISITION FOR THE SUPPLIES OR SERVICES REQUIRED.

The Program Office continually performs market research to monitor changes in the commercial marketplace, and determines if any software alternative is advantageous to the government. Although DFAS requires software specific to Nutanix, there are multiple authorized resellers available on SEWP.

12. DETERMINATION OF FAIR AND REASONABLE COST: The contracting officer will determine that the anticipated cost to the Government of the service/supplies covered by this justification will be fair and reasonable.

13. TECHNICAL/REQUIREMENTS REPRESENTATIVE CERTIFICATION:

I hereby certify that this justification is made in good faith, that the supporting data and information are accurate and complete to the best of my knowledge and belief, and that I would not be making this request if it were feasible to fully compete this requirement. I further certify that this request is not the result of lack of advanced planning or a desire to expend funds while those funds are still available.

Technical Reviewer

Name: Title: Signature

Requiring Activity/Program Management Office Certification:

Name: Title: Signature

14. CONTRACTING OFFICER'S CERTIFICATION: I hereby certify that this justification is made in good faith, that the supporting data and information are accurate and complete to the best of my knowledge.

Title: Contracting Officer

Name: Org. Code Signature

15. LEGAL SUFFICIENCY REVIEW:

Name: Signature

16. COMPETITION ADVOCATE REVIEW AND CONCURRENCE: (>\$750,000)

Name: Signature